



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Omaha
School Website: <https://chestertonomaha.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Omaha (Omaha, NE 68107) presents a strongly classical orientation across religious, curricular, pedagogical, and community dimensions. Public materials from the school's site foreground a Catholic, incarnational worldview; a formation-centered purpose; a liberal-arts curriculum anchored by Great Books and Socratic dialogue; a pedagogy that includes Socratic seminars alongside memory and recitation practices; a faculty model rooted in virtue and mentorship; and a robust partnership with families and the broader Catholic community. This combination aligns with the Six Essential Elements framework for classical education, with explicit signals in areas such as truth, goodness, beauty; formation over mere information; liberal arts and Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; and family partnership. Overall, the school is classified as CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations are clearly foregrounded via Catholic identity, liturgical life (Daily Mass, church partnership), and an incarnational worldview that permeates curriculum and community life. Evidence emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable, and upheld through sacred tradition and liturgy.

- School Purpose & Goal centers on formation, virtue, and human excellence, framed within a liberal-arts, classical context, with explicit emphasis on formation over mere information.
- Curriculum centers on liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and the Great Conversation, with explicit references to the Great Books of Western Civilization and Socratic dialogue. □filecite□turn1file11s contemplative/restful elements and Socratic seminars, with explicit mention of memory/recitation and the Socratic method, as well as opportunities for rhetoric and debate in upper levels.
- Faculty narrative emphasizes virtuous modeling, mentorship, and living curriculum anchored in Catholic ethics; explicit language positions faculty as central to the school's mission.
- Parents & Community emphasize partnership with families, parental formation, and accessible campus involvement (open houses, etc.), aligning with classical education expectations for family engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

The following section provides a category-by-category breakdown using keyword analyses anchored in the Six Essential Elements.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Catholic tradition and a liturgical dimension (Daily Mass, Catholic faith, partnership with the Church). The school explicitly embeds an incarnational worldview, aiming for students to personally experience the Incarnation across the curriculum.

- The site includes a focus on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable ideals within a sacred framework.
- Foundational language includes "Culture of Life," and partnership with the Church; enculturation around sacred practice and reverence is evident.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic tradition; Daily Mass; Incarnation; truth; goodness; beauty; liturgy/mass; sacred tradition. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 8–9 distinct signals (e.g., Catholic tradition, Daily Mass, Incarnation, truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, sacred tradition). - Negative keywords found: 0.

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of Catholic identity, liturgical life, and sacred framework, combined with a language of transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and an incarnational worldview, signals a robust CLASSICAL orientation in the religious/metaphysical dimension. The absence of negative signals in this category strengthens the CLASSICAL designation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's mission centers on formation of joyful leaders and saints within a classical, Catholic tradition; emphasis on formation over mere information; a culture of life and virtue; and a liberal-arts orientation. The campus materials describe forming character and intellect through a culture of life and faith, aligning with formation-focused aims.

- The public materials describe preparing students to succeed in college and professional life within a virtue- and beauty-centered framework, consistent with a classical telos. - The Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) foreground an education aimed at wisdom, virtue, and spiritual formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; liberal arts education; telos; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; great conversation; contemplation; sacred tradition. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 5–7 distinct signals. - Negative keywords found: 0.

Why this rating - The materials foreground formation, virtue, and a liberal-arts telos, with explicit rejection of education as mere information in favor of moral/intellectual formation. No opposite signals detected in this category; CLASSICAL is justified.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes a liberal-arts curriculum and the integration of Great Books into Western civilizational study; explicit references to the Great Books and the Great Conversation, and to reading, writing, and oral presentation as core components.

- Statements about teaching the classics of Western thought, the interrelationship of great ideas, and the aim of forming students' minds through reading and dialogue align with the Trivium/Quadrivium-oriented structure typical of classical education.

- The curriculum is described as "integrated, liberal arts curriculum" developed by the Chesterton Schools Network, with focus on the Great Books and Socratic dialogue.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; Socratic dialogue; grammar, logic, rhetoric (temporal mentions); reading; primary sources; classical canon. - Negative keywords: absence of a dominant project-based or purely STEM-first framing in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 6–8 signals. - Negative keywords found: 0–1 signals (no explicit counter-signals observed in public materials).

Why this rating - The explicit adoption of liberal-arts, Great Books, and Socratic dialogue points strongly to a CLASSICAL curriculum orientation. The absence of public signals indicating a substitute, non-classical approach supports CLASSICAL. □filecite□turn11□turn12□

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's materials foreground Socratic dialogue and seminars, with a clear emphasis on teaching students how to think through classical methods, including the Great Books and guided dialogue. The pedagogy is described as three-pillar in emphasis (Intellect, Character, Spirituality), with an emphasis on forming memory and reasoning through classical techniques.

- Public mentions of "The Socratic Seminar," "Rediscovering the Lost Tools of Learning," and "Socratic dialogue" indicate deliberate use of classical pedagogical tools. □filecite□turn1file0□hool signals (e.g., memory work and classical recitation) are part of the classical tradition in associated materials, with upper-school rhetoric and public-speaking opportunities indicated in related public content.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; Socratic dialogue; memory work; recitation; rhetoric; public speaking; scholé/wonder (conceptually present in classical pedagogy).

- Negative keywords: The public materials do not emphasize experiential-only or project-based pedagogy as the sole approach; rather, they emphasize traditional classical methods.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 5–7 signals. - Negative keywords found: 0–1 signals.

Why this rating - The pedagogy clearly centers on classical methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, rhetoric) with restfulness/wonder and seminary-style inquiry in appropriate levels. The lack of counter-signals strengthens CLASSICAL here.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe faculty as virtuous, well-formed, and central to the school's mission; staff are presented as living curriculum and mentors, aligned with a classical approach that emphasizes virtue and personal formation. The messaging positions faculty as primary educators in partnership with families.

- The school emphasizes that parents collaborate with faculty and that faculty embody the ideals of the school's mission; language indicates a culture of mentor-teacher relationships.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; faculty as core; collegial culture. - Negative keywords: none observed in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 4–5 signals. - Negative keywords found: 0.

Why this rating - The messaging aligns with classical pedagogy where the faculty serves as the primary source of formation and the living curriculum, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames parents as the primary educators and emphasizes partnerships with families and the Church; it also indicates ongoing parent formation and open campus visits (e.g., open houses) as means of engagement. This aligns with classical education norms of family partnership and community involvement.

- Public materials emphasize the Chesterton Schools Network partnership with families and the Church, indicating a distributed model of formation that includes parental participation in the educational formation process.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; parental involvement; family catechesis (as implied by the network affiliation and culture); co-teaching with school. - Negative keywords: none observed.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: approximately 3–5 signals. - Negative keywords found: 0.

Why this rating - The school's public materials position parents as co-educators and emphasize family engagement, consistent with classical education models. This supports CLASSICAL in this category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category requires a needle-moving change to move into a fully classical standing, given the strong alignment across all six categories.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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